



WELLNESS FOR EVERYONE

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The Ambé Guide Library

A Clean Living Reference Set

Eight doctor-curated guides to reducing your family's everyday toxic load — water, food, body care, home, pets, cleansing, fasting, and pharmaceutical alternatives.

10,000+ MEMBERS SERVED **85%** REPORT MEASURABLE IMPROVEMENT

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PRIORITY ONE

Water

Filter the shower, not just the tap

Roughly half of your total chlorine exposure during a shower comes from inhalation — not from water touching your skin.

- ✓ Warm water opens pores and vaporizes chlorine into steam
- ✓ Inhaled compounds bypass the liver and enter the bloodstream directly
- ✓ A 10-15 min hot shower can rival drinking 2L of the same water

Most households filter their drinking water and stop there — but the shower is a bigger, easily overlooked exposure route. Because inhaled compounds pass into the bloodstream through the lungs without first being filtered by the liver, a single hot shower can deliver a chlorine dose comparable to, or greater than, drinking several liters of the same water over a full day.

What to Watch For

- **Unfiltered hot showers**, especially long ones — duration and temperature both increase absorption and inhalation.
- **Standard carbon-only filters for chloramine**. Many municipalities now use chloramine instead of chlorine; basic carbon doesn't remove it — you need KDF-55 or catalytic carbon media.
- **Skipping filtration for kids**. Thinner skin and smaller lungs mean proportionally higher exposure per shower.

What to Use Instead

- **Shower filters**: Jolie Filtered Showerhead (NSF-177 certified, KDF-55), AquaBliss SF100/HD — install in minutes, no plumber needed.
- **Whole-house filtration**: Aquasana Rhino, Pentair Pelican, iSpring, or SoftPro's catalytic carbon systems for chlorine, chloramine, and PFAS reduction at every tap.
- **Drinking water**: Gravity filters (Berkey) or reverse osmosis (Aquasana, AquaTru) for the cleanest glass and cooking water.

Research: Dr. Julian Andelman (Univ. of Pittsburgh); Environmental Health Perspectives; American Journal of Public Health.

PRIORITY TWO

The Healing Kitchen

What you eat — and feed your family — matters

75% of conventionally grown produce tested by EWG in 2026 contained detectable pesticide residue.

- ✓ Whole, seasonal food is the most protective dietary habit available
- ✓ Seed oils skew the omega-6-to-omega-3 ratio toward inflammation
- ✓ Washing produce 20+ seconds meaningfully reduces (not eliminates) residue

Ultra-processed foods high in high-fructose corn syrup, industrial seed oils, and synthetic additives are consistently linked to chronic inflammation — a root driver of diabetes, cardiovascular disease, and autoimmune conditions. Building meals around whole, minimally processed food doesn't require perfection, just consistent direction.

2026 Dirty Dozen — Buy Organic

- Spinach, kale/collard/mustard greens, strawberries, grapes, nectarines, peaches, cherries, apples, blackberries, pears, potatoes, blueberries.
- **Also limit:** high-fructose corn syrup, industrial seed oils (soybean, corn, canola, cottonseed), and synthetic preservatives/dyes.

2026 Clean Fifteen — Safe Conventional

- Pineapple, sweet corn, avocado, papaya, onion, frozen sweet peas, asparagus, cabbage, cauliflower, watermelon, mango, banana, carrots, mushrooms, kiwi.
- **Favor:** olive oil, avocado oil, ghee, wild-caught fish, pasture-raised meat and eggs, legumes, and warming spices (turmeric, ginger, cumin).

Recommended apps: EWG Healthy Living (science-backed scoring from 60 regulatory databases) and Yuka (fast barcode scanning) for quick label checks while shopping.

EWG's 2026 Shopper's Guide to Pesticides in Produce.

Clean Body Care

What to use — and what to avoid

Just seven common cosmetic ingredients account for most of the documented hormone-disruption concern in personal care.

- ✓ Skin is porous — daily products add up to dozens of exposures before breakfast
- ✓ "Fragrance" on a label can legally hide dozens of undisclosed chemicals
- ✓ Avoiding a handful of named ingredients covers most of the risk

A short list of common cosmetic ingredients have well-established links to endocrine (hormone) disruption — meaning they can interfere with how the body produces or responds to hormones like estrogen and testosterone. These are specific, nameable ingredients, so avoiding them is a matter of reading labels, not overhauling your whole routine.

What to Avoid — Established Endocrine Disruptors

- **Parabens** (methyl-, propyl-, butylparaben) — can mimic estrogen; found in lotions, shampoos, makeup.
- **Phthalates** — often hidden inside the generic word "fragrance" or "parfum."
- **Oxybenzone** — a chemical sunscreen filter with documented hormone-disrupting activity; choose zinc oxide or titanium dioxide instead.
- **Triclosan** — an antibacterial in some soaps and toothpaste, also flagged for endocrine activity.

Clean Brands to Choose

- **OSEA, True Botanicals, Dr. Hauschka, Cleo+Coco** — formulated without parabens, phthalates, or synthetic fragrance.
- **Castile-based soaps** (like Dr. Bronner's) — a simple, multi-use, EWG-well-rated option for body, hand, and light cleaning.
- **"Unscented" or essential-oil-scented** products over anything listing plain "fragrance."

Recommended apps: Think Dirty (deepest cosmetic-only database) and EWG Healthy Living (Skin Deep database) — scan a barcode in-store for an instant hazard score.

EWG Skin Deep database; FDA cosmetic ingredient reviews.

Detox Your Home

Room by room

Only 7% of household cleaning products adequately disclose their full ingredient list.

- ✓ 53% of cleaners tested by EWG contain ingredients known to harm the lungs
- ✓ Cleaning products aren't required by law to list full ingredients
- ✓ A handful of pantry staples cover most everyday cleaning needs

Cleaning products are one of the least regulated categories on store shelves. When EWG evaluated over 2,000 household cleaners, roughly 22% contained chemicals that can cause asthma to develop in otherwise healthy people — a risk that's fully avoidable with the right products.

What to Avoid

- **Chlorine bleach** — can release chloroform fumes in poorly ventilated bathrooms.
- **Vague "fragrance" or "surfactant" listings** that don't disclose actual ingredients.
- **Formaldehyde-releasing preservatives** — a known carcinogen, sometimes hidden under other names.
- **BPA-containing plastics** in food storage — switch to glass or stainless steel where possible.

What to Use Instead

- **Seventh Generation, AspenClean, Branch Basics** — among the higher-scoring brands in EWG's Guide to Healthy Cleaning.
- **DIY basics:** castile soap, white vinegar, baking soda, and hydrogen peroxide cover most household needs.
- **HEPA + carbon air purifiers** (e.g., Coway Airmega), ventilation, and air-purifying houseplants (Snake Plant, Peace Lily, Boston Fern).

Recommended: EWG Healthy Living app (also rates cleaners) and Clearya, a free browser extension flagging harmful ingredients while shopping online.

EWG's Guide to Healthy Cleaning — a 14-month review of 2,000+ products against 15 toxicity databases.

Safe Nutrition for Pets

The same standards you hold for your own plate

Ethoxyquin is banned from human food in the U.S. — yet still permitted in many pet foods via preserved fish meal.

- ✓ Many pets eat the same processed formula for their entire lives
- ✓ Named proteins beat vague "meat by-product" every time
- ✓ Fresh or frozen formulas need fewer synthetic preservatives

The same processed-food concerns that apply to human diets apply to pets — arguably more so, given the lack of dietary variety most pets get. Several preservatives still common in mainstream kibble carry the same red flags researchers raise in human food.

What to Avoid

- **BHA and BHT** — synthetic preservatives classified as possible carcinogens.
- **Ethoxyquin** — banned from human food, still allowed in pet food, often undisclosed on the label.
- **Unnamed "meat meal" or "animal by-product meal"** — vague, unspecified sourcing.
- **Corn, wheat, and soy fillers, artificial colors, and carrageenan** — low nutritional value; carrageenan linked to intestinal inflammation.

What to Choose

- **JustFoodForDogs, Nom Nom, Open Farm** — named proteins, natural preservatives (vitamin E, rosemary extract).
- **Frozen or refrigerated fresh food** when possible — preserved by cold, not chemicals.
- **Labels with named proteins** ("chicken liver," "beef heart") rather than generic "by-products."

Veterinary nutrition reviews; FDA pet food ingredient guidance.

Seasonal Reset

Spring & fall cleansing protocol

A gentle seasonal reset supports your body's own elimination organs — no extreme protocol required.

- ✓ Cleansing in the Ayurvedic tradition is gentle, not punishing
- ✓ Timed to the two seasonal transition points — spring and fall
- ✓ A complement to whole-food eating, not a substitute for it

Ayurvedic cleansing is built around supporting the body's own elimination organs — colon and liver — at seasonal transitions, rather than extreme fasting or unregulated commercial "detox" products, many of which can do more harm than good.

What to Avoid

- **Extreme juice- or water-only fasts** without practitioner guidance, especially beyond a day or two.
- **Unregulated "detox tea" and cleanse supplements** — this category is largely unregulated; aggressive laxatives can disrupt electrolyte balance.
- **Treating a cleanse as a substitute** for ongoing whole-food eating rather than a seasonal complement.

Traditional, Gentle Protocols

- **Colon support:** triphala and psyllium husk, taken as directed, for regularity and gentle elimination.
- **Liver support:** a traditional ghee flush, or warm lemon water first thing in the morning.
- **Timing:** spring and fall, aligning with the body's natural seasonal transitions.

Educational overview of traditional Ayurvedic practice, not medical advice. Consult your Ambé doctor before beginning any cleanse.

Fasting & Autophagy

A beginner's guide to cellular renewal

A 2025 human study offered the first direct evidence that fasting increases autophagy in people, not just animal models.

- ✓ Autophagy is cellular housekeeping — the body recycling damaged components
- ✓ More discomfort does not mean more benefit
- ✓ Gentle time-restricted eating offers most of the practical benefit

Autophagy increases when insulin levels drop, which is why fasting became associated with it. But researchers are clear: benefits come from consistency, not extremity. Extended fasts carry real risk, while a gentle overnight window appears to capture most of the upside.

What to Avoid

- **Assuming "longer is always better."** Extended fasts beyond 24 hours should only be done under supervision.
- **Fasting with a history of disordered eating**, during pregnancy/breastfeeding, with diabetes, or on medications requiring food — check with your doctor first.
- **Ignoring warning signs** like dizziness, irregular periods, or persistent fatigue — these mean stop, not push through.

A Gentler Starting Point

- **Begin with a 12-14 hour overnight window** (e.g., dinner by 7pm, breakfast after 7-9am) rather than jumping to extended fasts.
- **Reduce constant snacking** to give the body real breaks between meals.
- **Pair with whole-food eating, movement, and 7-9 hours of sleep** — these compound with fasting's benefits.

Bensalem et al., "Intermittent time-restricted eating may increase autophagic flux in humans," *Journal of Physiology*, 2025.

Pharmaceutical Risks

And the natural alternatives with real evidence

In a 2024 clinical trial, boswellia reduced knee arthritis pain by up to 62% in 90 days — most felt it within five days.

- ✓ Curcumin performed comparably to ibuprofen/diclofenac in multiple trials
- ✓ Long-term NSAID use carries real GI, kidney, and cardiovascular risk
- ✓ These alternatives are best used alongside a practitioner, not instead of one

Over-the-counter pain relievers are reached for so routinely their risks are easy to overlook. Several traditional Ayurvedic botanicals have a genuinely credible, growing evidence base — more substantial than most "natural remedy" categories.

Know the Risks

- **Frequent or long-term NSAID use** (ibuprofen, naproxen) — linked to GI irritation/ulcers, kidney stress, and cardiovascular risk.
- **Habitual antacid use** — can reduce absorption of B12, magnesium, and calcium over time.
- **Self-directed high-dose supplementation** as a substitute for medical care rather than alongside it.

Evidence-Backed Alternatives (Discuss With Your Practitioner)

- **Curcumin (turmeric extract):** Comparable to ibuprofen/diclofenac for osteoarthritis pain in multiple trials, with fewer GI side effects. Typical dose: 500–1,500 mg/day with piperine for absorption.
- **Boswellia serrata:** 300–400 mg, up to three times daily.
- **Ginger:** shown to reduce exercise-induced muscle pain by up to 25%.

Kuptniratsaikul et al., *Clinical Interventions in Aging*, 2014; UCLA Health curcumin review, 2016. Educational only — do not stop a prescribed medication without medical supervision.

Important Notes

These statements have not been evaluated by the Food and Drug Administration. Products offered through Ambé are not intended to diagnose, treat, cure, or prevent any disease.

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